

In Search of Davos Man

Peter Gumbel

1 William Browder was born in Princeton, New Jersey, grew up in Chicago, and studied at Stanford University in California. But don't call him an American. For the past 16 of his 40 years he has lived outside the U.S., first in London and then, from 1996, in Moscow, where he runs his own investment firm. Browder now manages \$1.6 billion in **assets**ⁱ. In 1998 he gave up his American passport to become a British citizen, since his life is now centered in Europe. "National identity makes no difference for me," he says. "I feel completely international. If you have four good friends and you like what you are doing, it doesn't matter where you are. That's globalization."

i. 此处 assets 一定是复数,才表示资产 property;单数时,asset 表示优势,an advantage.

E.g. His wit is his chief asset. 他的优势是机智。

2 Alex Mandl is also a **fervent**ⁱⁱ believer in globalization, but he views himself very differently. A former president of AT&T, Mandl, 61, was born in Austria and now runs a French technology company, which is doing more and more business in China. He **reckons**ⁱⁱⁱ he spends about 90% of his time traveling on business. But despite all that **globetrotting**^{iv}, Mandl who has been a U.S. citizen for 45 years still **identifies**^v himself as an American. "I see myself as American without any hesitation. The fact that I spend a lot of time in other places doesn't change that," he says.

ii. Fervent means showing strong feelings. Its synonyms include passionate, zealous, enthusiastic, keen, ardent.

这里,借机会给同学们讲解 keen 这个词,出现频率非常高。Basically, keen means sharp, acute, sensitive, penetrating 敏锐的、锋利的、有穿透力的;it also means ardent, eager. For example, you can say "He is keen/eager to see you again." 他热切地想再见到你。此外,它还表示 excellent, wonderful, 如 The film Battle at Lake Changjin(《长津湖战役》) is a keen production of the director Xu Ke. 这里的 a keen production 表示导演徐克的心血之作。

iii. Reckon here means estimate, count, 估摸,估计。再比如:Try to **reckon** the height of the building.表示估一下这个建筑的高度。Reckon also means consider. E.g. The worst outcome must be **reckoned** before we launch the plan. 在这篇文章里,reckon 取前一层含义, count, estimate.

iv. Globetrotting = globe + trot. Trot is a verb; it means to run very slowly with short steps. 碎步慢跑。同学们熟知的“碎步跑”是 jog, jog ≈ trot; 该词的字面含义则是在全球漫步,即 travel to many different countries around the globe.

v. Identify is the verb form of identity. 中文含义为“确立/识别身份”。

E.g. Please identify yourself. 报上名来;

E.g. I cannot identify those codes. 我识别不出那些代码;

E.g. I can quickly identify the problem. 我能迅速看清问题。

“人以群分”,即拥有相同身份(identity)的人聚在一起。因此,identify 这个动词的另一层含义是“等同于”,“认为自己和别人属于(某一类)”这也解释了为什么它的形容词 identical 的含义为“相同的”,“等同的”。

E.g. Napoleon identifies as homosexual. 拿破仑认为自己是个同性恋; Alex Mandl identifies himself as an American.

E.g. I can almost identify with the despair she once experienced. 我几乎能感受到她

曾经经历过的那种绝望。这里的 identify 表示“自己感受到和别人一样的情感”。

3 Although Browder and Mandl define their nationality differently, both see their identity as a matter of personal choice, not an accident of birth. And not **incidentally**(=**accidentally** **这两个词在这篇文章里含义相近，同学们不需要做语义辨析。**), both are Davos Men, members of the international business **élite** who **trek** each year to the Swiss Alpine town for the annual meeting of the World Economic Forum, founded in 1971. This week, Browder and Mandl will join more than 2,200 executives, politicians, academics, journalists, writers and a handful of Hollywood stars for five days of networking, parties and endless **earnest** discussions about everything from post-election Iraq and HIV in Africa to the global supply of oil and the **implications**^{vi} of nanotechnology. **Yet this year, perhaps more than ever, a hot topic at Davos is Davos itself.**^{vii} Whatever their **considerable** differences, most Davos Men and Women share at least one belief: that globalization, the **unimpeded**(=**unstoppable, unpreventable**) flows of capital, labor and technology across national borders, is both welcome and unstoppable. They see the world increasingly as one vast, **interconnected** marketplace in which **corporations**(=**businesses, companies, firms**) search for the most **advantageous** locations to buy, produce and sell their goods and services.

vi. Implications means **possibilities**, 表示各样的可能性。文中指的是纳米技术的潜在意义。The verb form is imply. Imply ≈ signify, suggest 暗示，意味着。

vii. 句法上，**more than ever** 用来修饰谁？这个句子可以写成：Yet this year, a hot topic **to be discussed** more than ever is Davos itself. 语义上，“a hot topic of Davos itself” can be interpreted into several layers of meaning: 1)the topics about the meaning of being a Davos Man, 2)the survival of the Davos Man-dominated globalisation, and 3)the potential **gospels or benefits Davos men could possibly bring to the humanity as a whole, etc.**

4 As borders and national identities become less important, some find that **threatening** and even dangerous. In an essay **entitled** "Dead Souls: The Denationalization of the American Elite," Harvard Professor Samuel Huntington describes Davos Man (a phrase that first got widespread attention in the 1990s) as an emerging global superspecies and a threat. The members of this class, he writes, are people who "have little need for national **loyalty**, view national **boundaries**(=**borders**) as obstacles that thankfully are **vanishing** (=disappearing), and see national governments as **residues**(=**antiques, 古董, 遗迹**) from the past whose only useful function is to **facilitate** the élite's global operations." Huntington argues that Davos Man's global-citizen self-image **is starkly**(=**sharply, absolutely**) **at odds with** the values of most Americans, who remain deeply **committed to**^{viii} their nation. This disconnect, he says, creates "a major cultural fault line. In a variety of ways, the American establishment, governmental and private, has become increasingly **divorced**(= different, **alienated** **与某物脱离的，即不同的**) from the American people."

viii. 本科阶段要求同学们记忆 Commit 两层含义：1. to do, perform 做出（非法、错误的事情），如 commit a crime, 犯罪；commit a mistake, 犯错；2. bind, devote oneself to sth,将自己捆绑于、奉献给某一事情，I devote/commit/bind myself to art.（我捆绑自己于艺术，即我将精力放在艺术上）；原文 who remain deeply **committed to** their nation = who remain deeply **devoted or bound to** their nation.

5 Naturally, many Davos Men don't accept Huntington's terms(术语). Klaus Schwab, the founder and executive chairman of the World Economic Forum, argues that **endorsing**^{ix} a

global **outlook** does not mean **erasing**(=remove 移除, 抹去) national identity. "Globalization can never provide us with cultural identity, which needs to be local and national in nature."

ix. Endorse here means to support or approve of sth publicly, 公开认可、支持某个观点、人、事物等。Outlook here simply means view, viewpoint.

6 Global trade has been around for centuries; the corporations and countries that benefited from it were largely **content**^x to treat vast parts of the world as places to **mine**(=explore, 开采) natural resources or sell **finished products**(成品). Even as the globalization of capital **accelerated**(=increased speedily) in the 1980s, most foreign investment was between relatively wealthy countries, not from wealthy countries into poorer ones. U.S. technology, companies and money were often at the **forefront** of this movement.

x. 我们做一个词音辨析:

- Con'tent, 重音在第二个音节时, 表示 satisfied, glad 乐于, 满足的;
- 'Content, 重音在第一个音节时, 表示内容。

再来做一个词形与词义辨析:

- Con'sent means to agree, approve, 表示赞同. E.g. She consented. 她答应了;
- Con'tent means satisfied, glad. E.g. She is content with her current life.
- Con'tend means to argue, 争辩, 反驳; 其形容词为 contentious, likely causing argument 引发争议的; (这是我们上学期小测测过的词汇)
- Con'test means to compete, challenge 竞争, 挑战; e.g. Donald Trump contested for power. (本学期 Unit 1 Text B 中的词汇)

7 However the past two decades have witnessed the rise of other significant players. The developed world is **beating a path to** China's and India's **door**^{xi} -- and Chinese and Indian companies, in turn, have started to look **overseas**^{xii} for some of their future growth. Beijing has even started what it calls a "Going Out" policy that encourages Chinese firms to buy assets **overseas**. Asian nations are creating "a remarkable environment of innovation," says John Chambers, chief executive of Cisco Systems. "China and India are **graduating** currently more than five times the number of engineers that we are here in the U.S." That means that U.S. and European companies are now facing high-quality, low-cost competition from overseas. No wonder so many Western workers worry about losing their jobs. "If the issue is the size of the total pie, globalization has proved a good thing," says Orit Gadiesh, chairman of Bain & Co. "If the issue is how the pie is divided, if you're in the Western world you could question that."

xi. Beat a path to one's door means to be eager to do business with that person. 急切地寻求和他/她合作的机会;

xii. Oversea is the British spelling; overseas is the American spelling. 这两者拼写皆正确。Overseas 既是形容词, 也是副词。这一段的两处 overseas 都是副词;

xiii. 同学们熟知的 "She graduates from USTC" 是 graduate 这个词的不及物动词形式。它完全可以做及物动词。Graduate means to grant/offer an academic diploma or degree to... 授予学位。原文 China and India are graduating currently more than five times the number of engineers that we are here in the U.S.. 表示中国与印度每年授予多美国五成的工程师学位。

8 The biggest **shift**(=change) may just be starting. A **landmark** 2003 study by Goldman

Sachs predicted that four economies -- Russia, Brazil, India and China -- will become a much larger force in the world economy than widely expected, based on **projections**^{xiv} of demographic and economic growth, with China **potentially** overtaking Germany this decade. By 2050, Goldman Sachs suggested, these four newcomers will likely have **displaced** (=replace) all but the U.S. and Japan from the top six economies in the world.

xiv. 此处的 projections 是该词最不常见的用法。It means an estimate of future possibilities based on a current trend. 即基于某种趋势下的预判，它也可以替换成 predictions, estimates.

9 It's also entirely possible that the near future may see the **pendulum**(钟摆) of capital **swing** away from Davos Man-style globalization. One counterpoint is Manila Woman -- low-paid **migrant** workers from Asia and elsewhere who are increasingly providing key services around the world. Valerie Gooding, the chief executive of British health care company BUPA, says the British and U.S. health care system would break down without immigrant nurses from the Philippines, India, Nigeria and elsewhere. Unlike Davos Man, she says, they're not **ambivalent**(being in an attitude of both positive and negative, 态度暧昧, 模棱两可的) about being strongly **patriotic**(loyal to their own country).

10 Not all Davos Men seek global markets, either. Patrick Sayer runs a private equity firm in France called Eurazeo, and complains there are still too many **barriers** to cross-border business in Europe, let alone the world. So he's focused Eurazeo on its domestic market. "I profit from being French in France. It's easier for me to do deals," Sayer says. "It's the same elsewhere. If you're not Italian in Italy, you won't succeed."

11 That may sound like a narrow **nationalism**, yet it contains a hidden wisdom. Recall that Italy itself was, until 1861, not a unified nation but an **aggregation**^{xv} of city-states. Despite **tension**^{xvi} between its north and south, there's no contradiction between maintaining a regional identity and a national one. Marco Tronchetti Provera, chairman of Telecom Italia, for example, can feel both Milanese and Italian at once, even as he runs a company that is **aspiring**^{xvii} to become a bigger international presence. The question is whether it will take another 140 years for Davos Man to figure out how to **strike the** same **balance** on a global scale.

xv. Aggregate 表示集合。The Western Zhou Dynasty(西周)shared some similarities with Italy before 1861. The Zhou Dynasty was an aggregation of vassal states(附庸国) who sent tributes to the kings of Zhou before Qin unified China (秦并天下)。其反义词是 segregate(segregation), 分离。

xvi. 我们从 tension 这个词可以派生出除了 nervous 之外的另一个种表达“紧张的”词汇，叫做 tensed。因此，同学们以后除了讲 I'm nervous (低于四级的表达)，还可以用 I'm tensed, 更加书面化。

xvii. 我们做一个词形辨析：Acquire, aspire, inspire.

Aspire means to strive for, seek eagerly to obtain...努力争取，积极追求。所以，Aspiration means a strong desire.表示远大志向、抱负。注意，aspire 是一个不及物动词，后面必须接 to. E.g. She aspires to a career in literature. 她期待干文学这一行。
Acquire means to obtain sth from learning, 获得，获取；
Inspire simply means to motivate, encourage, 激励。